DAILY QUIZ · 13 NOVEMBER 2026 · 10 MIN READ

Bajaj Pune Grand Tour, Season 2

The Bajaj Pune Grand Tour is India's international road cycling stage race, run on roads our customers ride every weekend. Season 1 in January 2026 was a hit, and Season 2 is bigger in every way. Customers will ask about it for the next three months. Know it cold.

Everything below is from the official website, punegrandtour.in, as published on 13 November 2026. The site says the detailed schedule with timings will follow, so do not quote start times yet.

1. Season 2 at a glance

- **Dates:** Tuesday 26 January to Sunday 31 January 2027. It starts on Republic Day.
- **Six road stages**, one each day, with no prologue and no rest day.
- **Total distance:** 960.12 km. **Total climbing:** 10,473 m.
- **Classification:** UCI 2.1. Season 1 was UCI 2.2.
- **Field:** 150+ riders in the Men Elite race.
- The site also lists a **Pro Men's Race** of 437 km at UCI 2.2 level and a **Gran Fondo**, with details still to be confirmed.
- More than 50 pit stops are planned along the route.

2. What UCI 2.1 means

The UCI is cycling's world governing body. In a race code, the first number is the type: **2 means a stage race**, 1 means a one-day race. The number after the dot is the class: **.1 is Class 1, a level above .2, which is Class 2**.

The upgrade was announced on 7 October 2026. It means more UCI ranking points for riders and teams, and a stronger, more international field. In general, Class 1 races may invite the sport's top-tier WorldTeams, which Class 2 races cannot.

Pune has also been awarded the **2032 UCI Road World Championships**, the first time India will host them. The Grand Tour is part of building towards that.

3. The six stages

STAGE	DAY	START	FINISH	DISTANCE	CLIMBING
1	Tue 26 Jan	The Ladies Club, Camp	Nanded City, Sinhgad Road	177.36 km	2,352 m
2	Wed 27 Jan	Tiranga Circle, Baramati	Saswad Municipal Council, Saswad	154.0 km	1,212 m
3	Thu 28 Jan	Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Square, Junnar	Hutatma Rajguru College, Rajgurunagar	130.34 km	1,855 m
4	Fri 29 Jan	Shree Sant Dnyaneshwar Vidyalaya, Alandi	Bhagwan Mahavir Chowk, Lonavala	178.78 km	1,800 m

5	Sat 30 Jan	Bhagwan Mahavir Chowk, Lonavala	TCS Circle, Hinjewadi	142.39 km	2,206 m
6	Sun 31 Jan	PIECC, Moshi (PCMC)	Balgandharv Rang Mandir, JM Road	177.25 km	1,048 m

4. What each stage is like

- **Stage 1, the big opener.** Out of Camp through Kondhwa and Bopgaon to Narayanpur, south to Kapurhol and Sangamner, then west through Velhe and back via Khed Shivapur, Kondanpur, Ghera Sinhagad and Khadakwasla. It has the most climbing of any stage.
- **Stage 2, the rolling one.** Baramati to Morgaon, down to Nira, a loop around Jejuri, then Parinche and Mandhar into Saswad. It has the least climbing of the five stages outside the city.
- **Stage 3, short and hard.** The shortest stage, through the rugged country west of Junnar near the Bhimashankar forest, then south to Rajgurunagar. The website says this is where "the legs get a proper workout".
- **Stage 4, the longest.** A quiet start in Alandi, through Bhosari and Chikhali, then into the Maval hills with long loops before the finish in Lonavala.
- **Stage 5, the mountain day.** Lonavala to Ambavne, Tail Baila Phata and Tamhini, then east through Varasgaon and Pirangut to Hinjewadi. It is the second-shortest stage but has the second-most climbing, so it is the steepest day per kilometre.
- **Stage 6, the city finale.** A circuit race through Pimpri-Chinchwad and Pune: Chikhali, Bhosari, Nigdi, Ravet, Wakad, Balewadi, Kothrud, Sarasbaug, Shaniwar Wada. A loop through Aundh and University Chowk is ridden twice before the finish on JM Road. It is the flattest stage and suits the sprinters.

5. Reading the numbers

- **Longest:** Stage 4, 178.78 km. **Shortest:** Stage 3, 130.34 km.
- **Most climbing:** Stage 1, 2,352 m. **Least:** Stage 6, 1,048 m.
- **Steepest per kilometre:** Stage 5, about 15.5 m of climbing per km. Stage 1 is about 13.3 and Stage 6 about 5.9.
- Three stages are over 177 km: Stages 1, 4 and 6.

A stage race is won on total time across all stages. The hilly days, Stages 1, 3 and 5, are where the overall race is most likely to be decided. Flat days like Stage 6 usually end in a bunch sprint.

6. Season 2 against Season 1

	SEASON 1, JANUARY 2026	SEASON 2, JANUARY 2027
Format	Prologue plus 4 stages, 5 race days	6 stages, 6 race days
Distance	429 km	960.12 km
Climbing	3,840 m	10,473 m
Longest stage	134 km	178.78 km

UCI class	2.2	2.1

Season 1 had 29 teams and 171 riders from 35 countries, including two Indian teams: the Indian Cycling Team and the Indian Development Team. An estimated 2.5 million people watched from the roadside.

Familiar roads return:

- Season 1's Stage 2 also ran from The Ladies Club to Nanded City, but over 105.3 km. This year's Stage 1 uses the same start and finish over 177.36 km.
- Season 1's Stage 3 went from Saswad to Baramati. This year's Stage 2 runs the other way, Baramati to Saswad.
- Season 1's Stage 1 started at TCS Circle, Hinjewadi. This year Stage 5 finishes there.
- The tour finishes at Balgandharv Rang Mandir on JM Road, as it did last year.

7. Who is behind it

The race is an initiative of District Pune, led by the Pune and Pimpri-Chinchwad municipal corporations, with PMRDA and the Maharashtra Police. Bajaj is the title sponsor, and the Cycling Federation of India selects the Indian teams. The stated aim is to make Pune a global cycling hub and reclaim its name as the "City of Cycles".

8. Why this matters in the store

- **It brings new people into cycling.** Last year's race sent many first-time buyers to bike shops. Expect the same from December to February.
- **Brands we sell race here.** Quick Pro Team and Burgos Burpellet BH both rode Season 1. We list Quick Pro framesets and BH bikes. Use it.
- **The routes are ride ideas.** A customer who wants to "ride a Grand Tour stage" needs an endurance road bike, climbing gears and a GPS computer. Stage 5 through Tamhini and Stage 1 around Sinhagad are the dream routes.
- **Roads will close.** Stage routes are closed while the race passes. Tell customers to check official notices before planning a ride or a drive in race week.
- **Do not guess.** If a customer asks about start times, the Gran Fondo or registration, say the details are not announced yet and point them to punegrandtour.in.

Remember these

- 26 to 31 January 2027. Six stages, 960.12 km, 10,473 m of climbing, UCI 2.1.
- Stage 1 has the most climbing, Stage 4 is the longest, Stage 3 the shortest, Stage 5 the steepest, Stage 6 the flattest.
- Stages 4 and 5 share Lonavala. The finale is a city circuit ending at Balgandharv Rang Mandir, JM Road.
- Season 1: 429 km, UCI 2.2, 29 teams, 171 riders, 35 countries.
- Timings, Gran Fondo and registration are not announced. Do not guess.